Setting up your team's work

A guide for managers and department heads

Shah Investors Home Limited

Every picture here is the real application, and the red numbers on it match the numbered notes beside it — where the text says 1, look for the 1 in the picture.

The one idea to take from this guide:
you do not hand out recurring work. You describe the obligations a seat carries, once, and the system issues the work on schedule for as long as somebody holds that seat. Most of what follows is how to describe them well.

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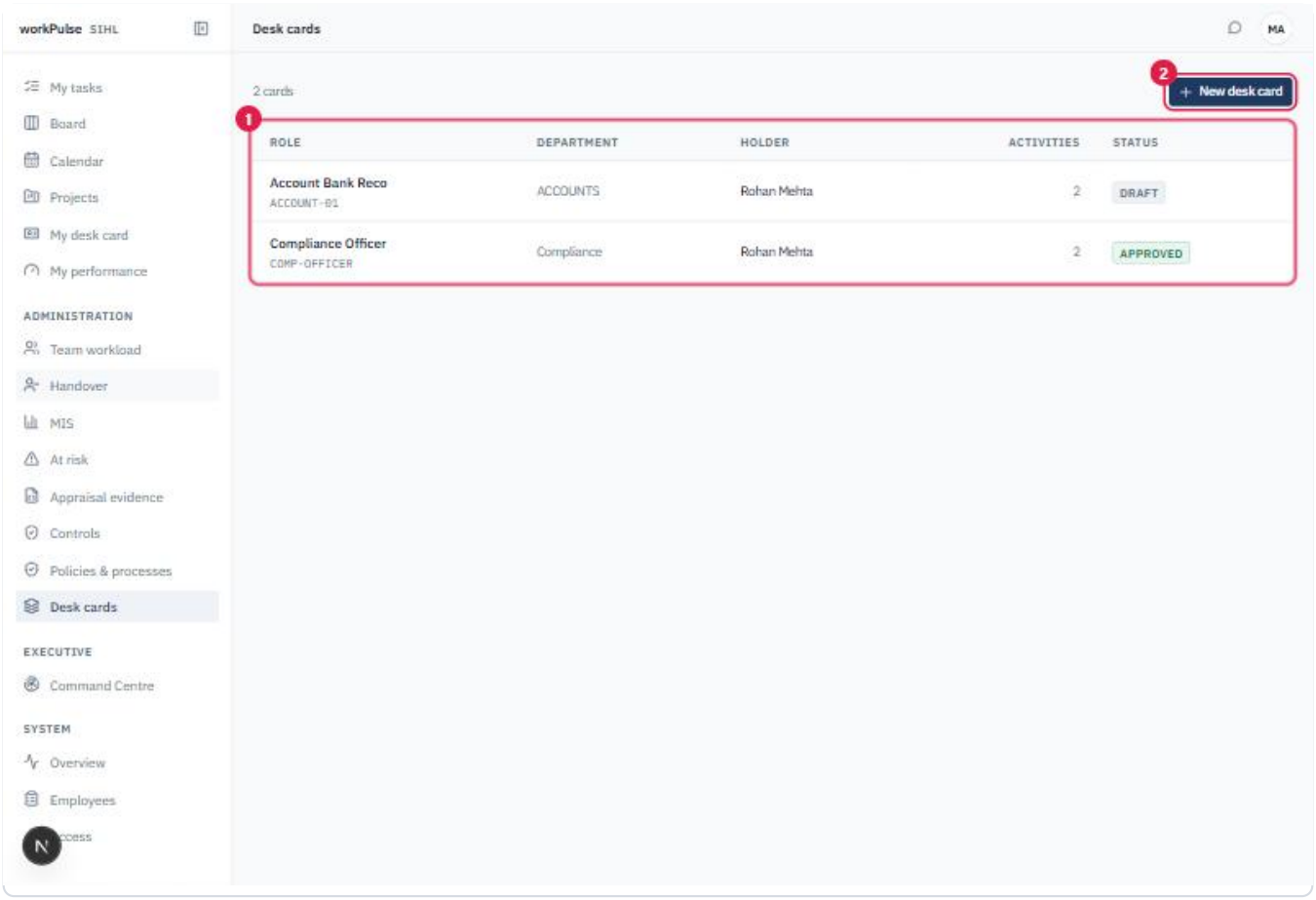
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Screens shown with sample data on an internal system. Creating desk cards and approving activities needs the department head or system administrator role.

SETTING UP RECURRING WORK

1. Two kinds of work

Before anything else, the distinction the whole system turns on. A task is one piece of work. A desk card is the standing obligations that come with a seat — and it is the thing that creates the tasks, by itself, on schedule. If the work repeats, you do not assign it: you put it on a desk card once.

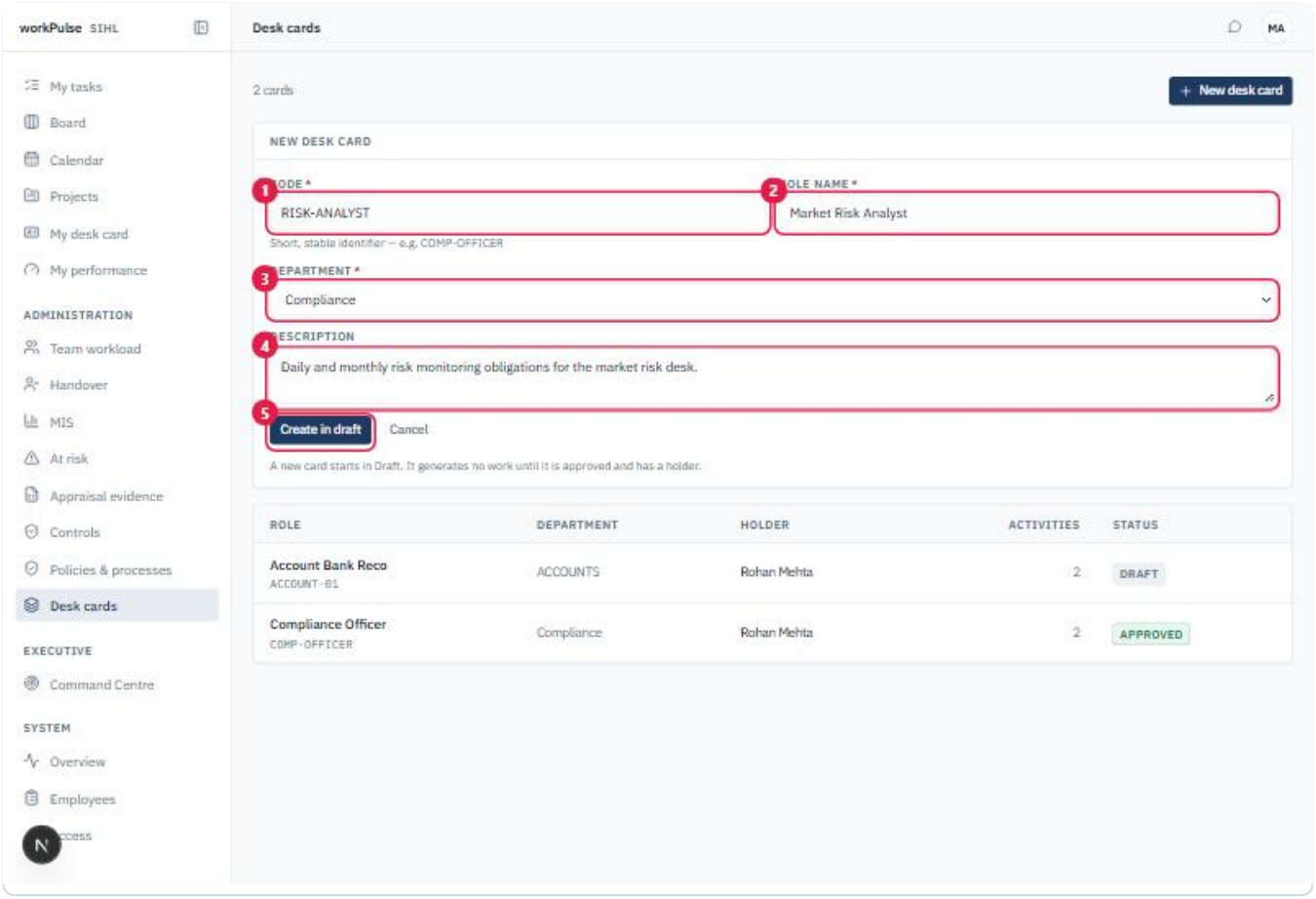


1. The cards in your department: the role, who holds it, how many obligations it carries, and whether it has been approved.
2. Start a new one.

> *A card belongs to the seat, not the person. When somebody moves on, the card and everything on it transfers — which is why nothing has to be reconstructed from memory the week they leave.*

2. Create the card

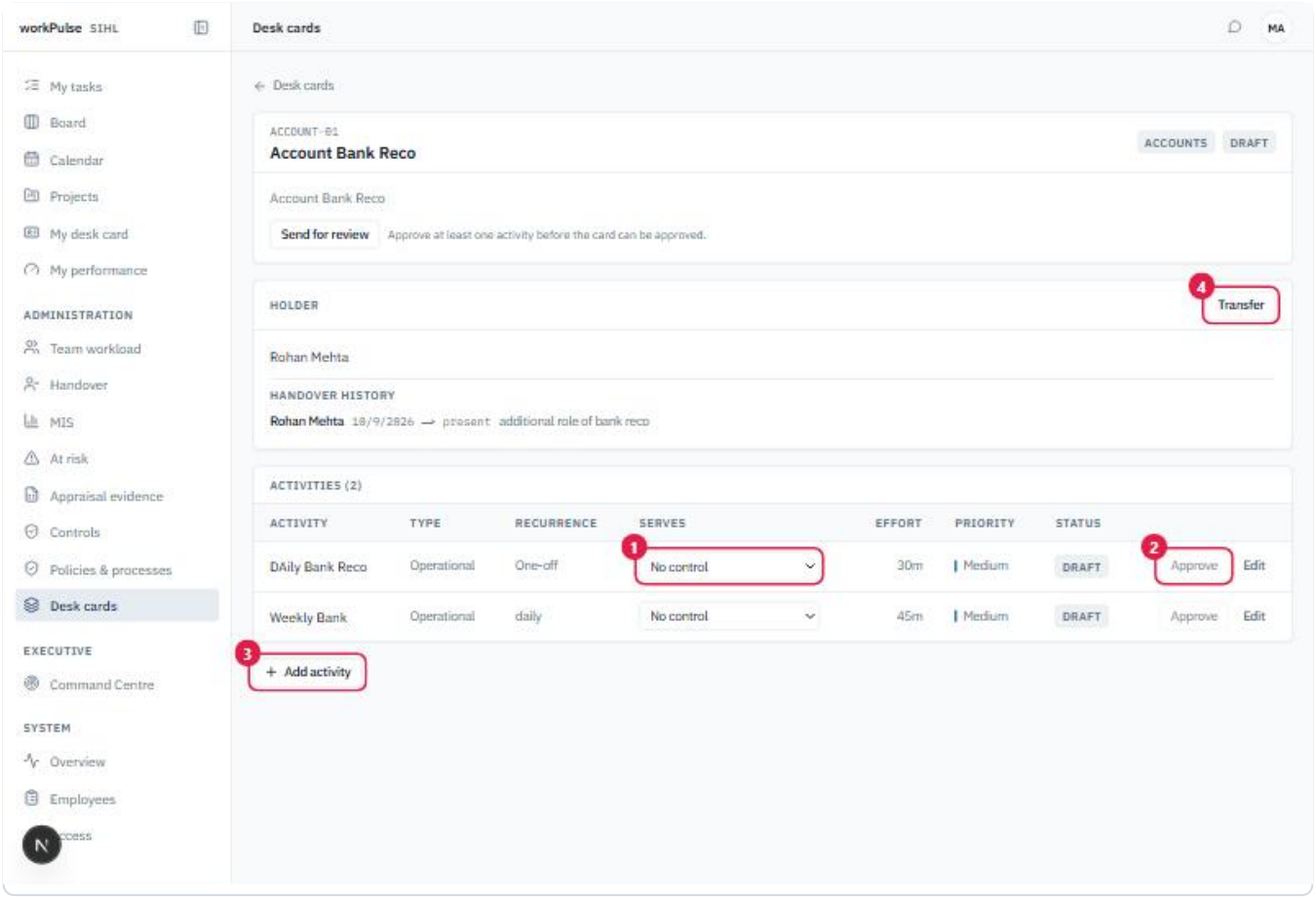
Name the role, not the person. “Market Risk Analyst”, not “Priya's work”.



1. A short, stable code you can quote — it outlives whoever holds the seat.
2. What the role is called.
3. The department it sits in.
4. What the seat is for. Worth writing: it is what the next holder reads first.
5. Creates it in draft. It generates nothing until it is approved and has a holder.

3. The card before it does anything

A draft card with obligations on it, none of them live yet. This is the state most of the work happens in.



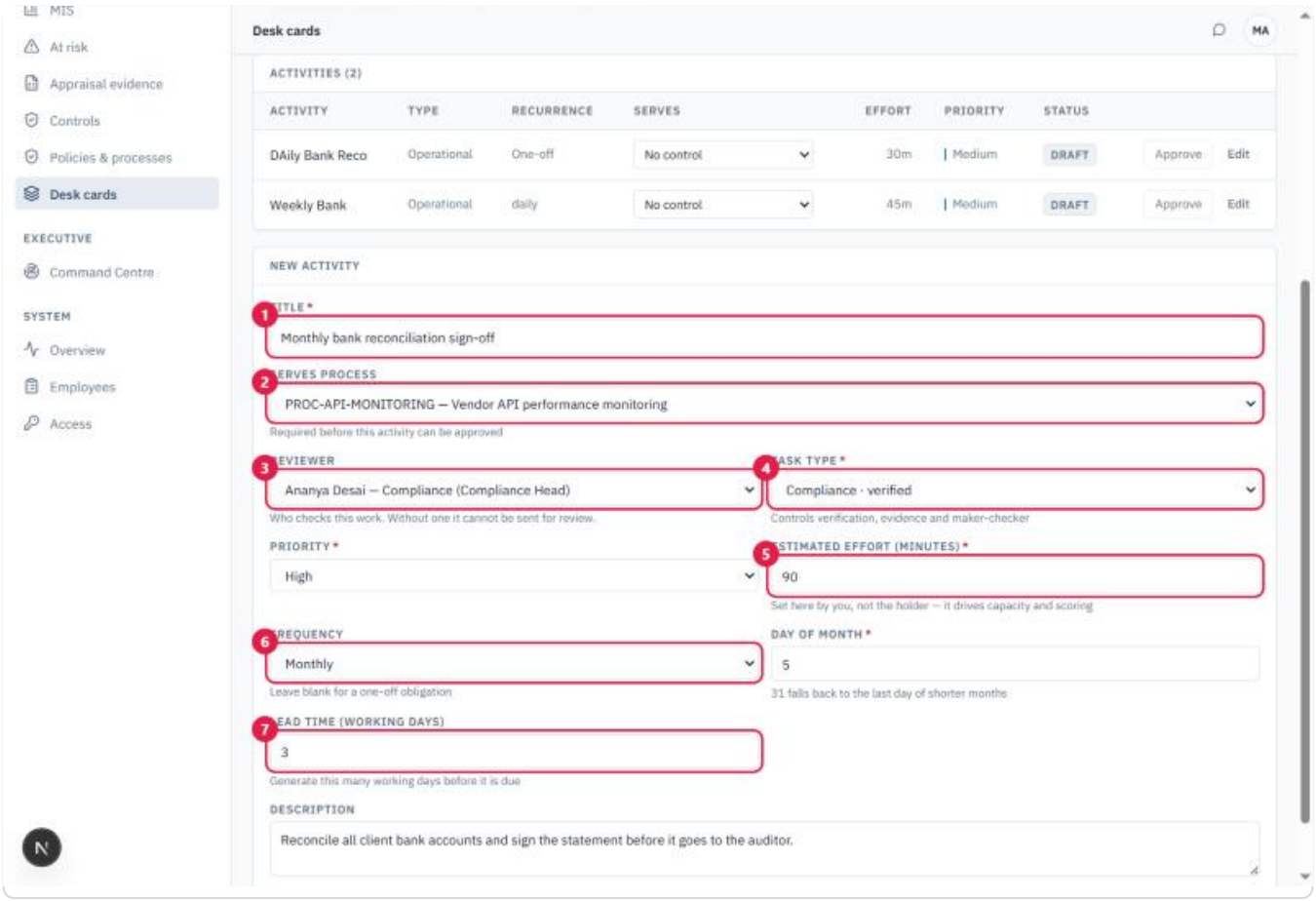
1. Serves — the control each obligation exists for. Until this is set the activity cannot be approved.
2. Approve is greyed for exactly that reason: offering a button and then refusing it teaches people the screen is unreliable.
3. Add another obligation.
4. Transfer the card to whoever holds the seat. A reason is required, and the history is kept rather than overwritten.

> *An unassigned card generates no work. If your team's recurring tasks have stopped appearing, check the holder first.*

SETTING UP RECURRING WORK

4. Adding an obligation

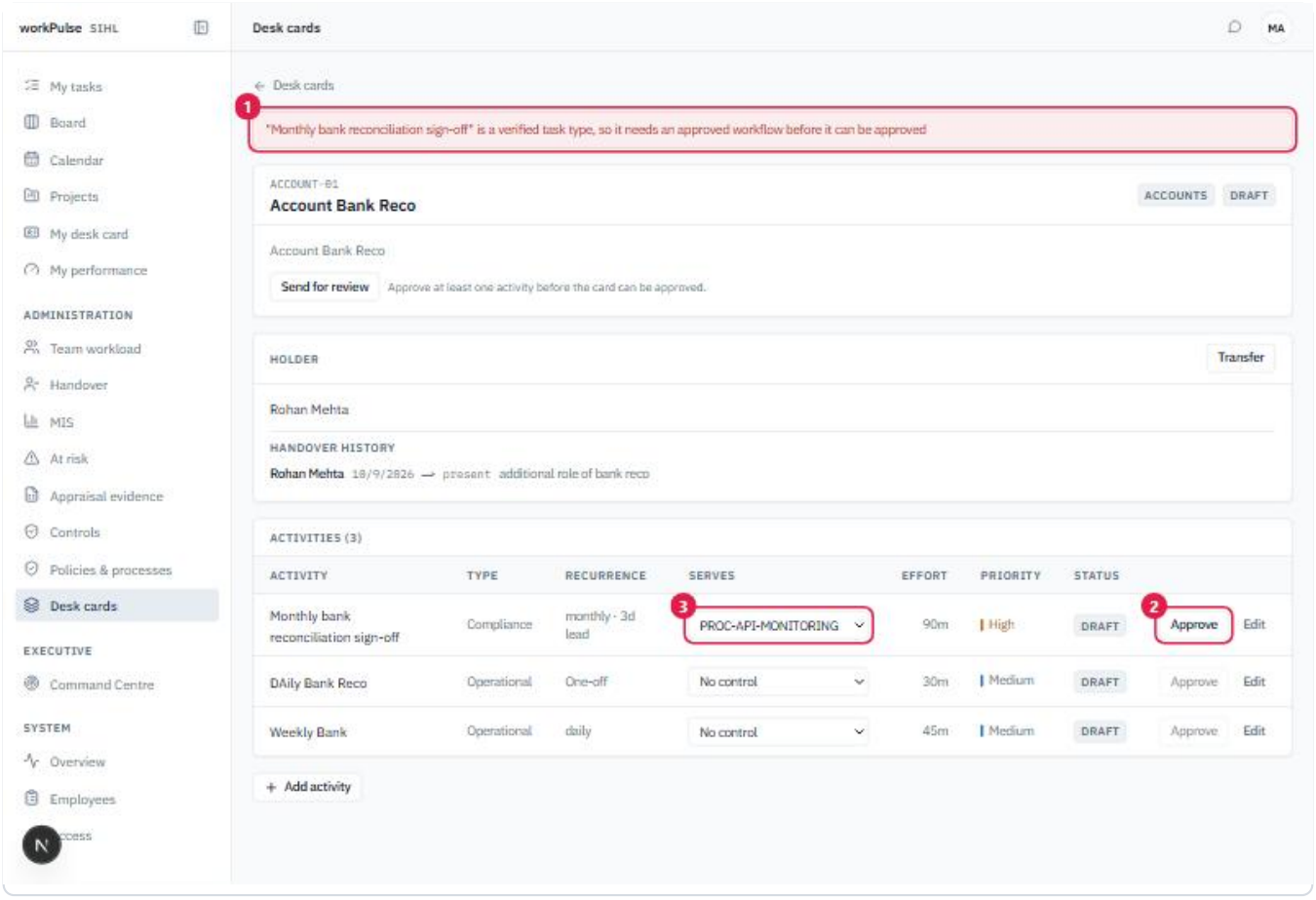
This is the form that matters most. What you set here decides what your team is asked to do, how often, and who checks it — every month, without anybody remembering.



1. What the work is. Specific enough that somebody new could act on it.
2. The control it serves. Required before approval, so nobody is left answering “why does this task exist?” with a shrug.
3. Who checks it. Without a reviewer the work cannot be sent for review at all.
4. Task type. This decides whether the work needs verification, evidence or maker-checker.
5. How long it should take — set by you, not the holder. It drives capacity and the workload figures.
6. How often. Leave blank for a one-off obligation.
7. Lead time: generate it this many working days before it is due, so nobody receives a filing task on the morning it is due.

5. When it refuses to approve

Two prerequisites catch people out. Both are deliberate, and both say so in plain words rather than failing silently.

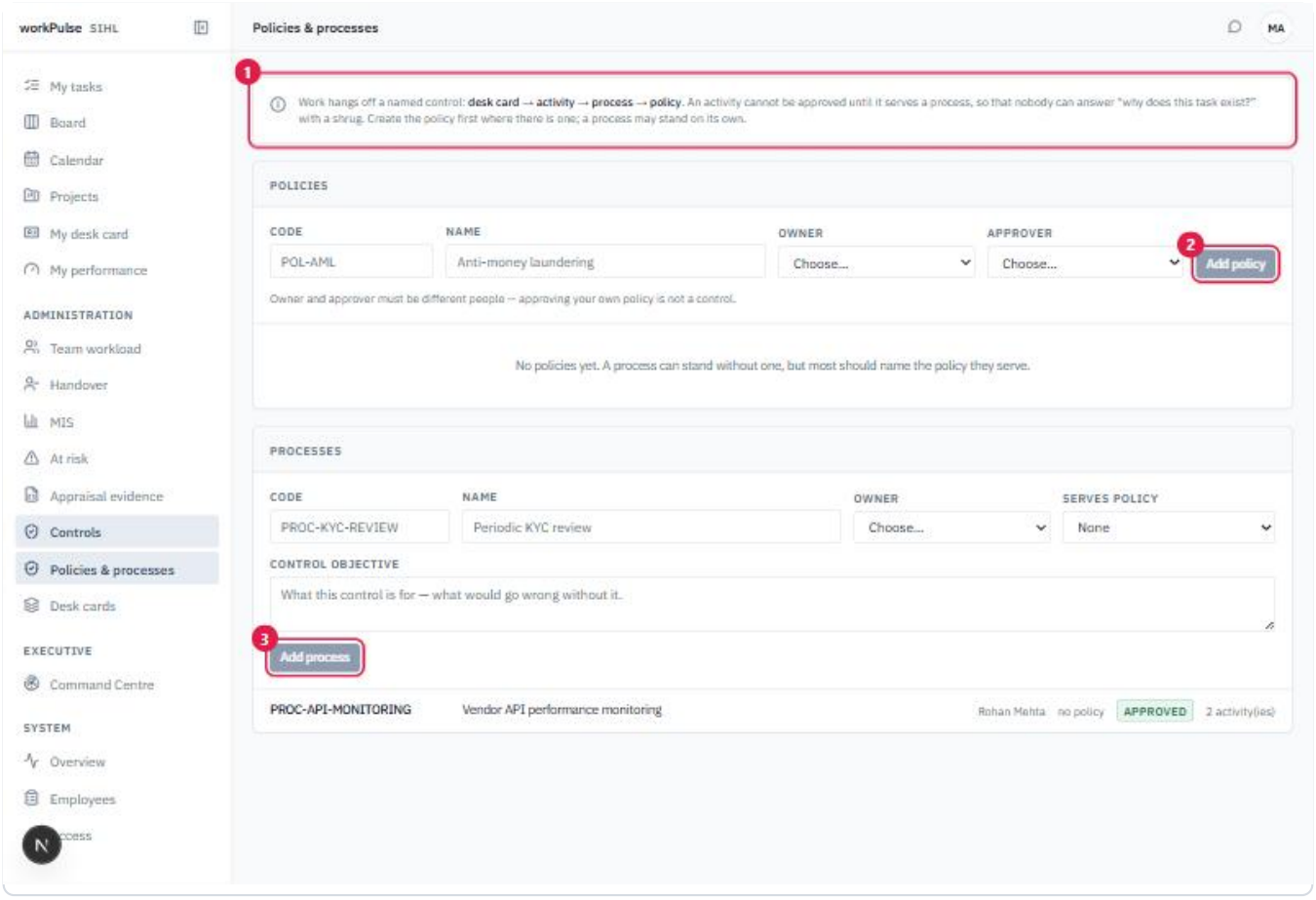


1. A verified task type needs an approved workflow as well as a control. Compliance work has steps somebody signed off; the activity cannot go live before they exist.
2. Approve, once the prerequisites are met.
3. The control. Set it here if you did not set it on the form.

> *If you only need the obligation recorded and generated, choose an operational task type. Reserve the verified types for work where somebody must check the steps were followed.*

6. If the control does not exist yet

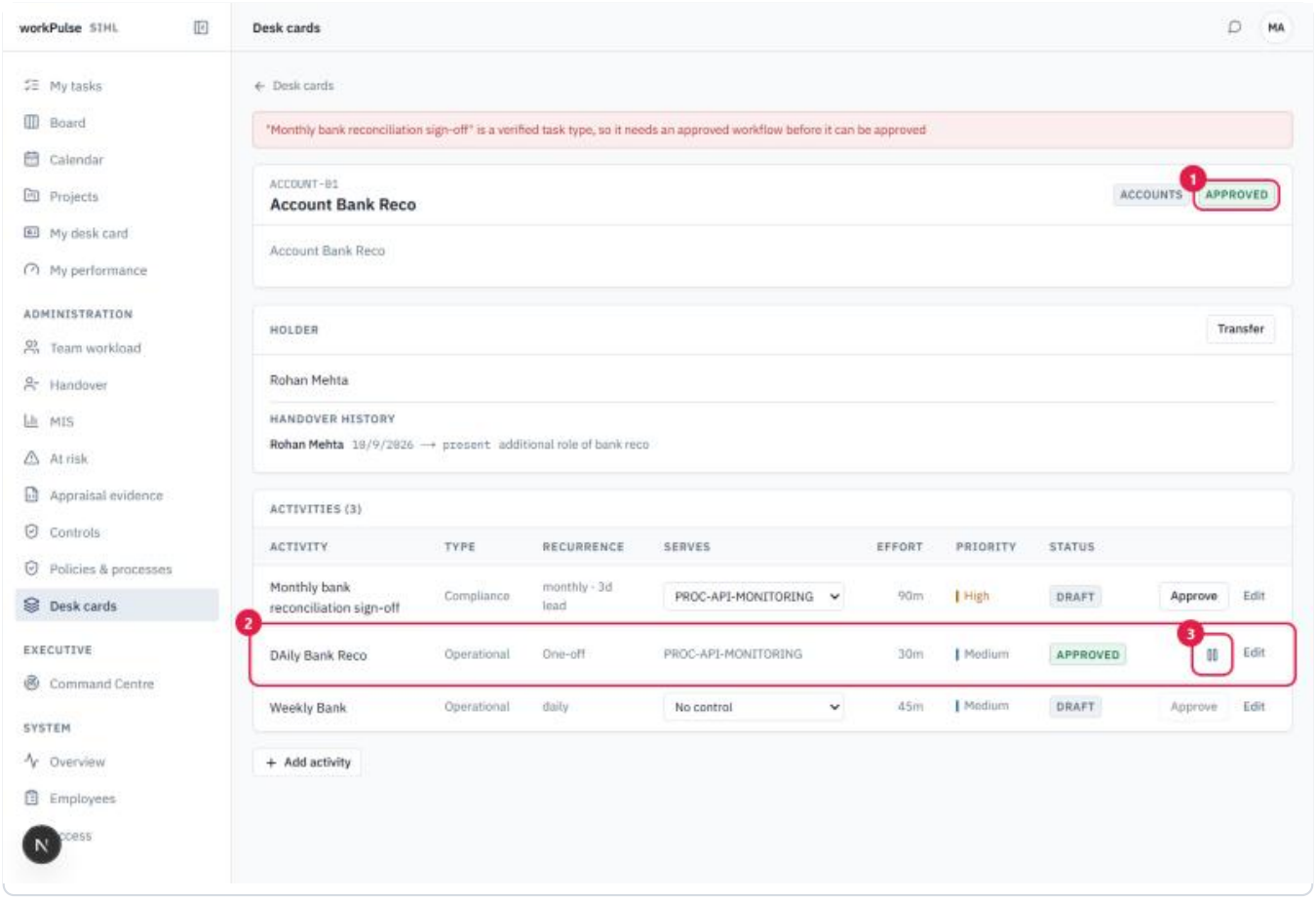
Work hangs off a named control: desk card !’ activity !’ process !’ policy. If the process you need is not in the list, create it under Policies & processes first.



1. The chain, in one line.
2. Add a policy. Its owner and its approver must be different people — approving your own policy is not a control.
3. Add a process. A process can stand without a policy, but most should name the one they serve.

7. Approve it, and it runs

Approve each activity, then the card. From here the work appears on its own, assigned to the holder, with the lead time you set.

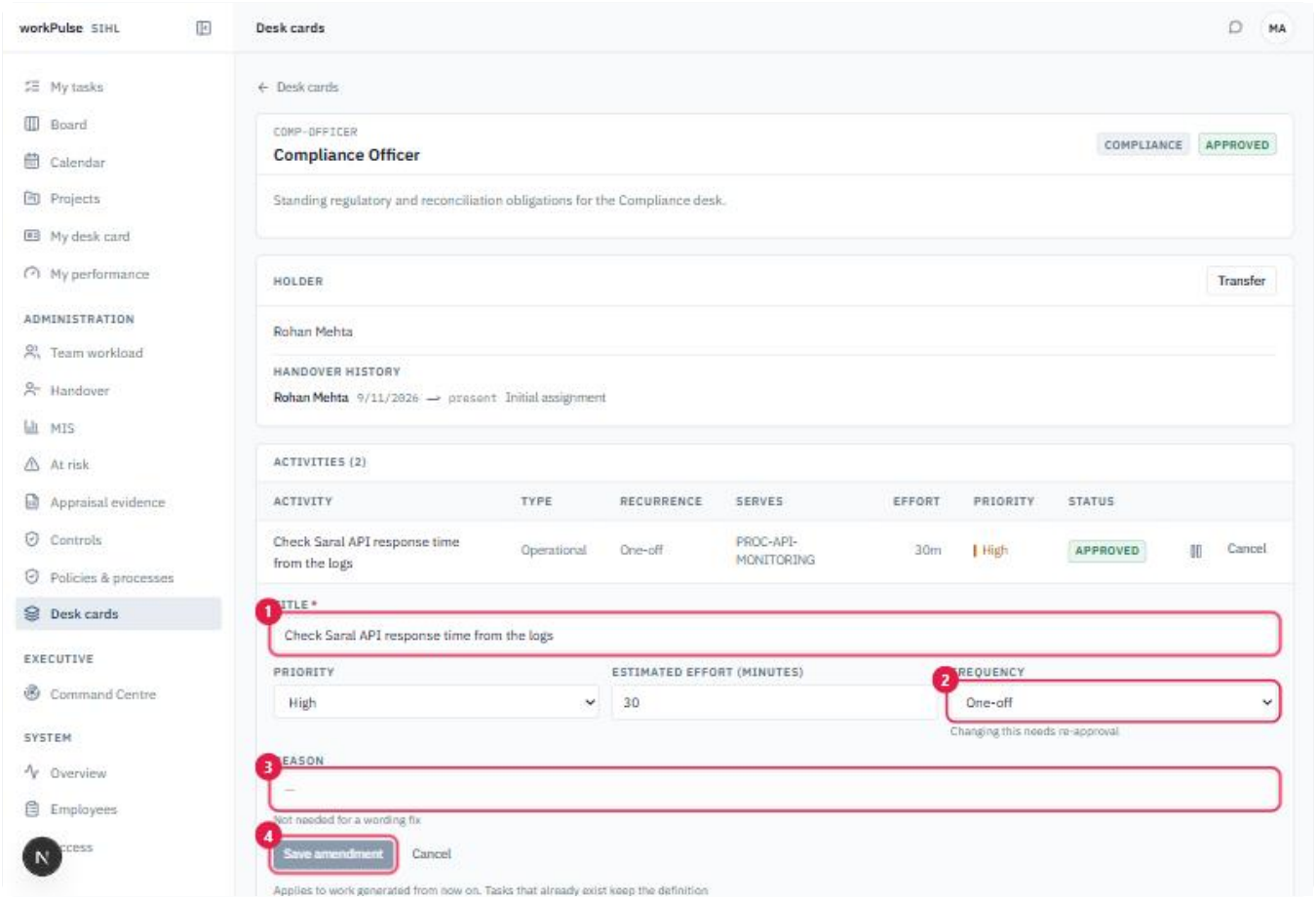


1. The card is approved.
2. So is the obligation. Note that its control is now fixed text rather than a dropdown — an approved activity's control does not change casually.
3. Pause generation. Use this when a process is suspended rather than deleting the activity, so the obligation and its history survive.

> *Tasks generated this way say “Desk card” as their source. Your team does not have to be told about them; they arrive.*

8. Changing it later

Corrections are made in place rather than by retiring the activity and creating a new one. What a change counts as depends on what it does, not which field moved.



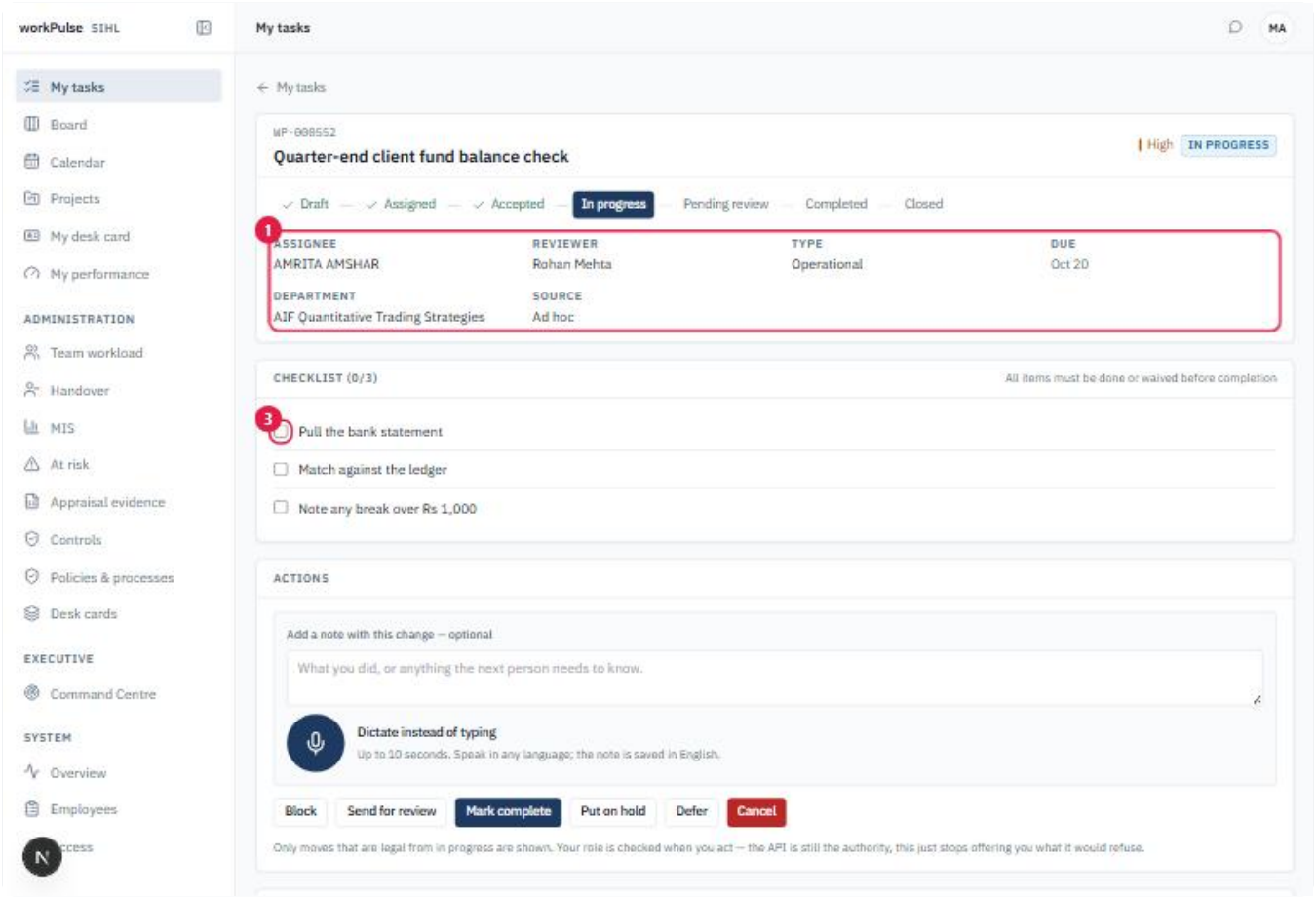
1. Wording — a typo or a clearer title. No reason asked.
2. Recurrence — this changes what work exists, so an approved activity goes back to draft and has to be approved again.
3. A reason, required as soon as the change is more than wording.
4. Save.

> *Amendments apply to work generated from now on. Tasks that already exist keep the definition they were created under — an auditor has to see the obligation that actually applied, not a later revision of it.*

DAY TO DAY

9. What you set on a single task

Whether the task came from a desk card or was raised directly, these are the fields that decide how it behaves.



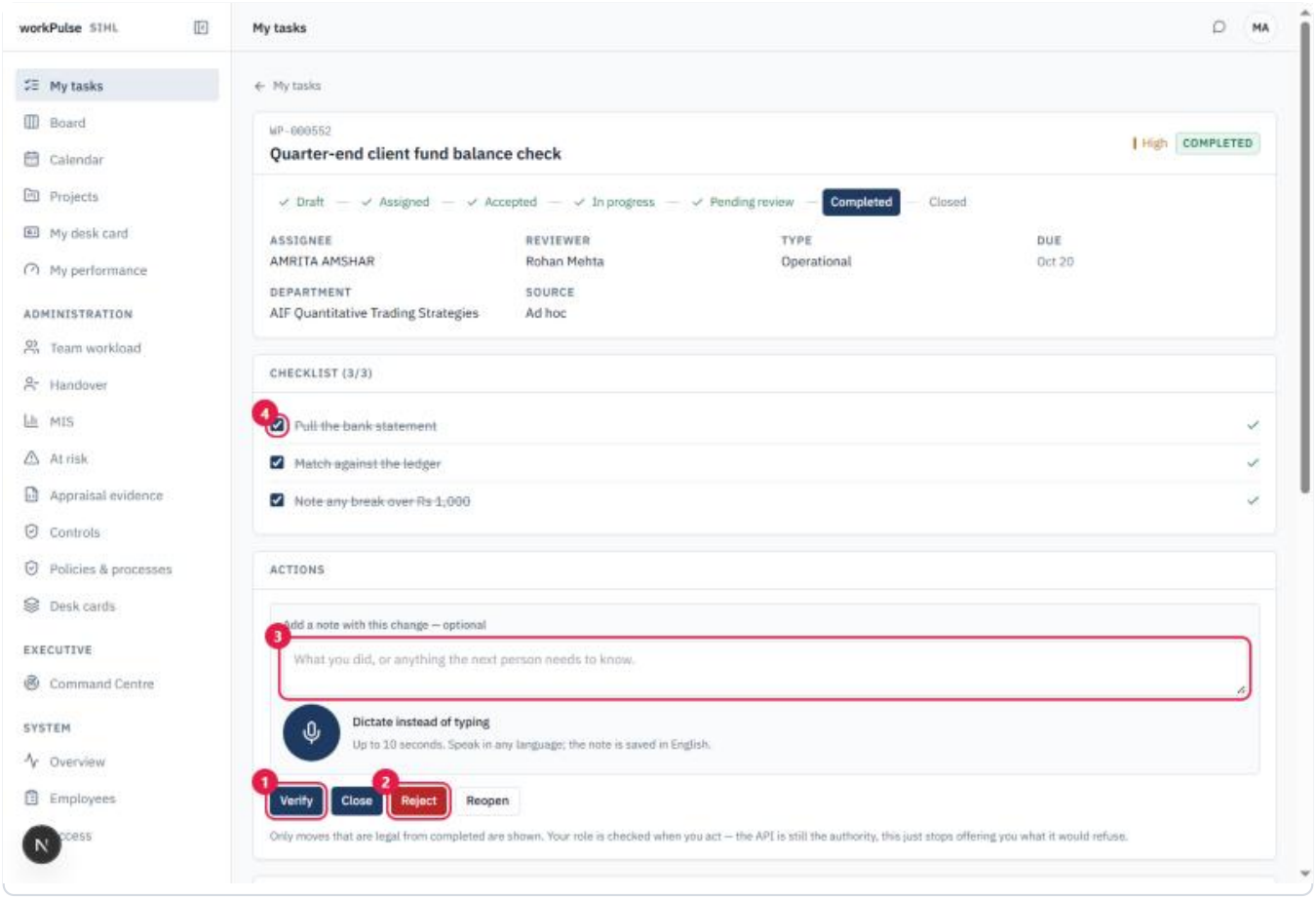
1. Assignee, reviewer, type and due date. One assignee at a time — co-ownership is modelled with subtasks, never a second name here.
2. A checklist. Every item must be done or explicitly waived before the work can be completed, which is how “done” stops being a matter of opinion.
3. Each item, ticked by whoever does the work.

> *The checklist is the cheapest control you have. Three specific lines beat a paragraph of description, and they double as evidence that the steps were followed.*

DAY TO DAY

10. Checking your team's work

When work is completed it waits for the named reviewer. This is the manager's half of the loop.



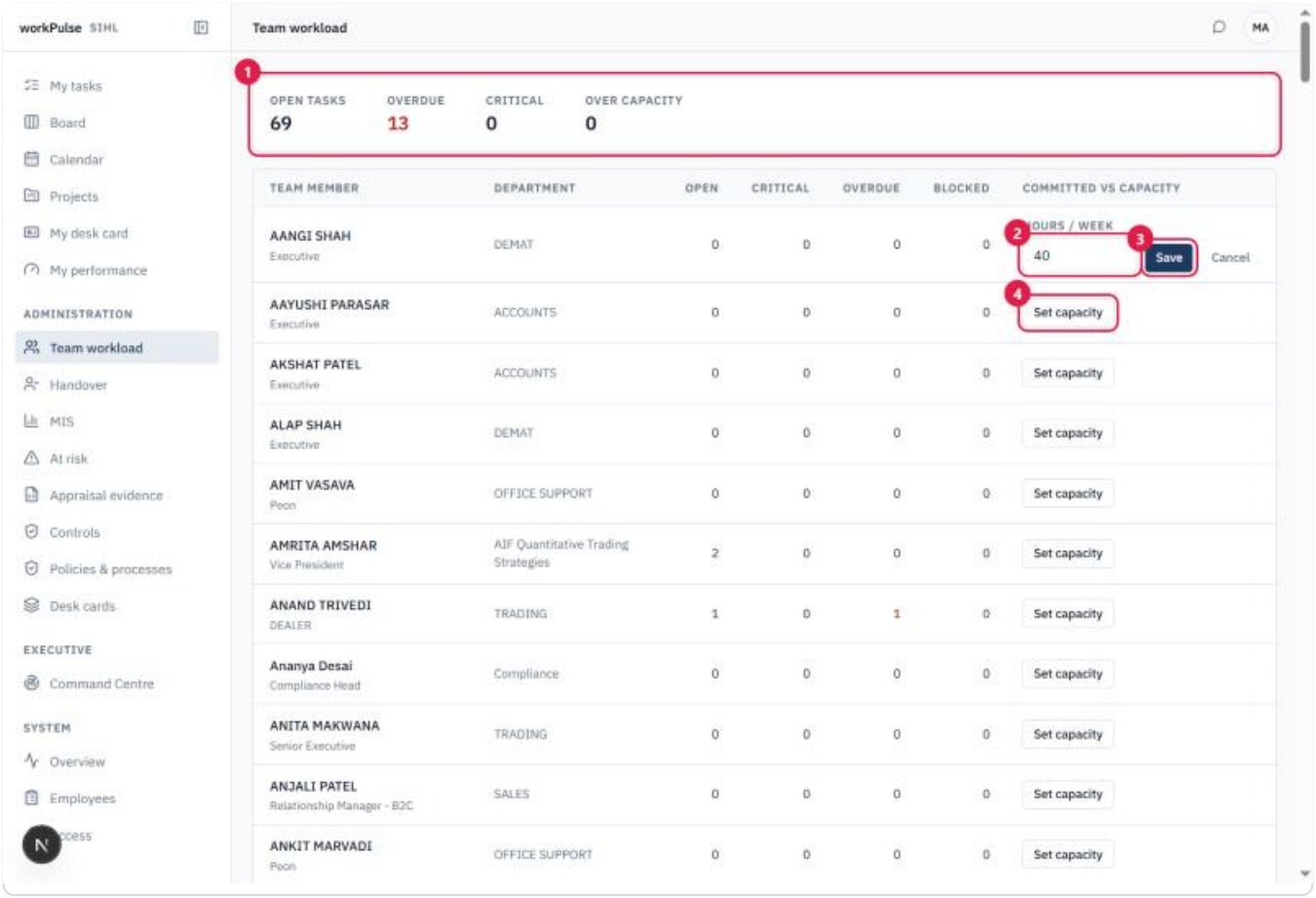
1. Verify — you are satisfied it was done.
2. Reject sends it back, with your reason recorded.
3. A note, which is what an auditor reads alongside the dates. Dictation works here too.
4. The checklist, now complete, shown with what was ticked.

> *Nobody can verify their own work, under any role — not even a system administrator. If you are both the assignee and the reviewer, the system will refuse you, and it is right to.*

DAY TO DAY

11. Capacity, and who is carrying what

Team workload is the one screen to open each morning: open work, what is overdue, what is critical, what is blocked and on whom.



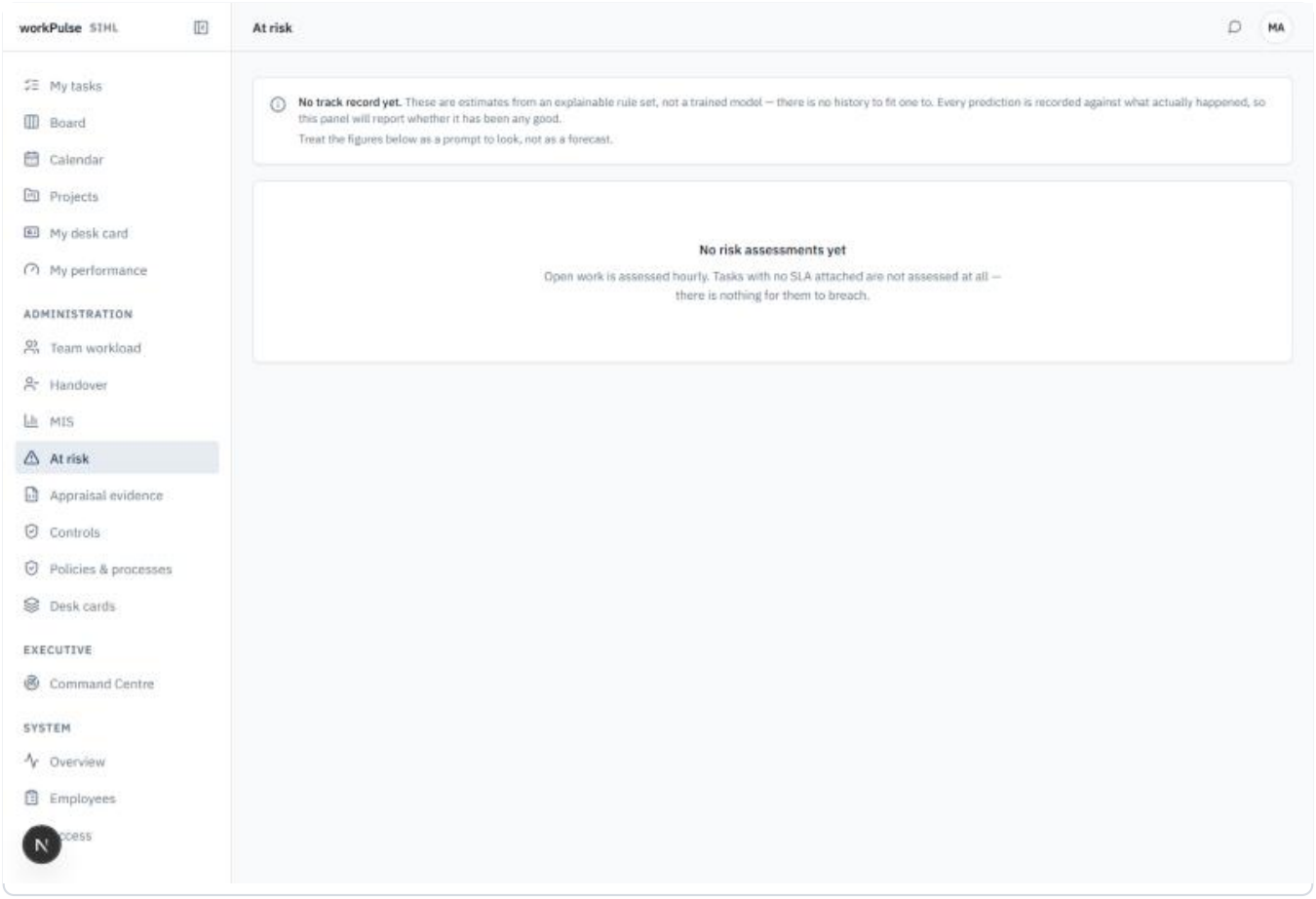
1. The totals for your team.
2. Hours a week this person can realistically absorb.
3. Save it.
4. Set it for everyone else. Until a person has a capacity, over-capacity cannot be calculated and they will never be reported as overloaded.

Committed hours come from the approved activities on their desk card. If somebody's committed time already exceeds their capacity, that is a staffing fact, not a performance one — and it is visible before it becomes a missed deadline.

DAY TO DAY

12. Work that is going to be late

At risk assesses open work hourly and lists what is likely to breach, with the reason.



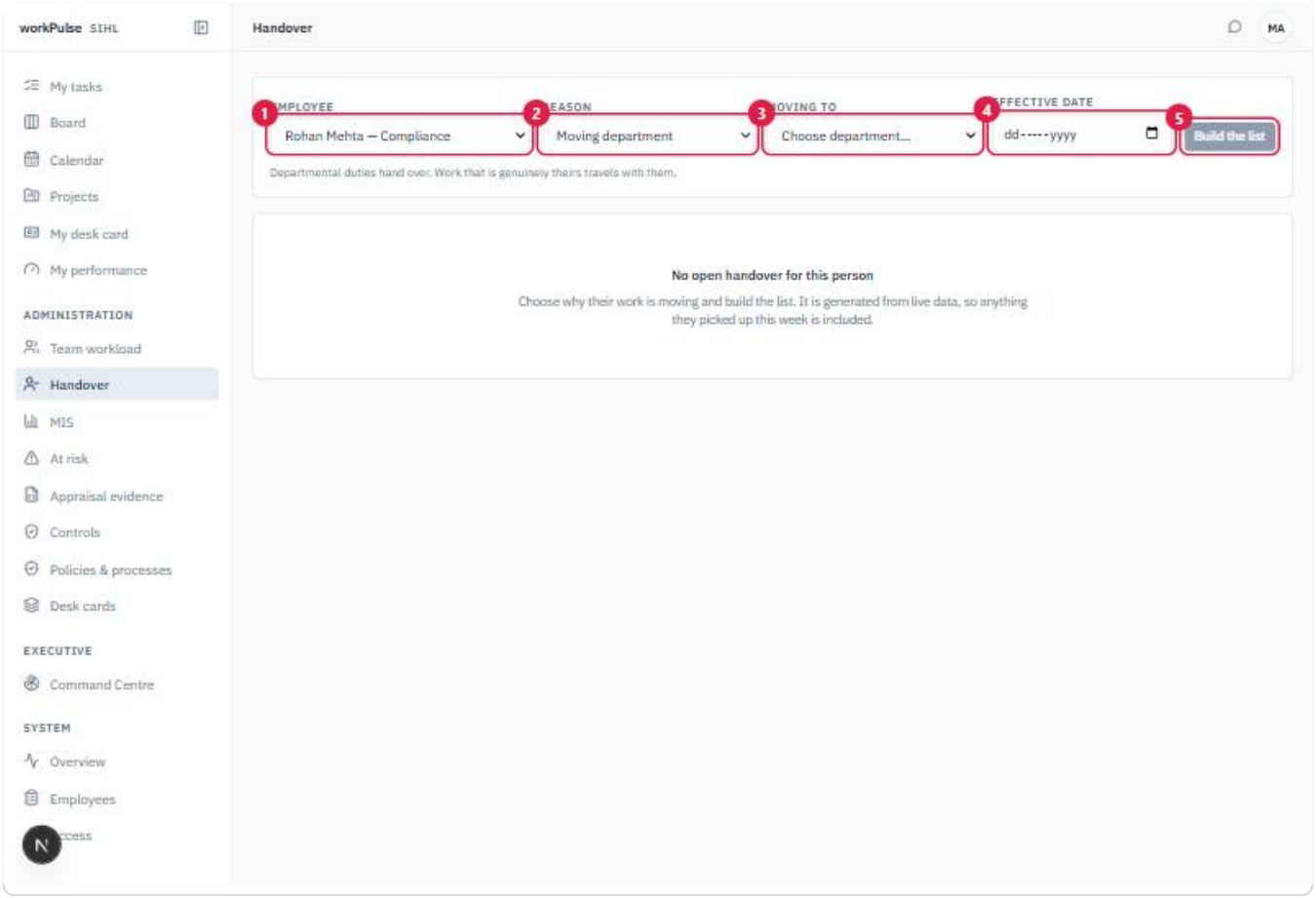
1. It will say so when it has no track record. These are estimates from an explainable rule set, not a trained model, and every prediction is scored against what actually happened.

Empty for now because tasks with no SLA attached are not assessed at all — there is nothing for them to breach. It fills up once SLA targets are defined for your task types.

DAY TO DAY

13. When somebody leaves or moves

Handover builds the list from live data rather than from memory — desk cards held, open tasks, project roles, delegations.



1. Who is moving.
2. Why. Leaving and changing department are not the same: somebody moving desks keeps their project roles, somebody leaving does not.
3. Where they are going.
4. When it takes effect.
5. Build the list, then decide item by item what hands over and what stays. Both are recorded.

DAY TO DAY

14. What you cannot do yet

Worth knowing before you go looking for it:

- Raise a one-off task for somebody from a screen. The capability exists in the system and desk cards generate work automatically, but there is no “new task” form yet — so ad-hoc work currently has to come from a desk card or from an integration.
- Reassign a task to a different person. Not built at all; today the route is to cancel and raise again, which loses the history.
- Edit a task's due date, priority or checklist after it has been created.
- Set an SLA target yourself — those are configured centrally, and until they exist the At risk screen stays empty.

The first two are the ones a manager hits in week one. They are small pieces of work rather than missing design — say the word and they can be built.